Student (B2-C1)

I. Read the text. For each question (1-5), choose the correct answer.

The History of Fashion Shows

Fashion shows have become a renowned symbol of creativity and cultural expression, firmly rooted in the evolution of the fashion industry. Their origins can be traced back to the mid-19th century when the concept of showcasing clothing through live models began gaining prominence. A landmark for the modern fashion show occurred in 1903, directed by Charles Frederick Worth, often hailed as the "father of haute couture." This lavish event in Paris consecrated live displays as a captivating theatrical performance that would shape the future of fashion exhibitions.

By the 1920s, fashion shows had become extravagant displays that not only highlighted garments but also embodied the spirit of the Jazz Age. Designers such as Coco Chanel and Elsa Schiaparelli embraced avant-garde themes, becoming not only fashion designers but, one might say, cultural commentators, as they responded to the spirit of the age in surprising ways. Their presentations became immersive experiences, utilising music and dance to create a sensory landscape that captured the zeitgeist of the era. During this period, fashion shifted towards self-expression, challenging societal norms and revolutionising women's wear.

The 1960s saw the identification of the teenager as a consumer. For the first time, adolescents were recognised as an audience, and the industry became preoccupied with catering to its needs and wants. Designers like Mary Quant introduced the miniskirt, a landmark moment that transcended mere fashion—it represented a paradigm shift towards women's liberation and empowerment. Fashion shows became arenas where bold statements about culture and politics were expressed through the clothing itself. They thus not only captured ideas that were floating around, but also reinforced them, pushing against the boundaries of traditional norms

Marked by individualism, the 1980s witnessed the rise of supermodels, who became cultural icons and symbols of aspirational lifestyles. Designers increasingly emphasised theatricality and visual storytelling in their showcases, with Jean-Paul Gaultier's iconic "Les Garçons" show in 1984 setting the bar high. In hindsight, the supermodel culture of the 1980s is generally seen as having promoted unhealthy body standards, but it also exhibited a type of gender fluidity that resonated with contemporary socio-cultural movements and made the fashion world a safe space for gender misfits, those who felt they did not want to be straitjacketed by predefined roles.

The globalisation of fashion shows through live-streaming and social media has democratised access, allowing audiences worldwide to engage with collections in real time. Recent shows have also embraced sustainability as a core value, with designers pivoting towards environmentally conscious materials and practices, reflecting a growing awareness of fashion's ecological footprint. Nonetheless, many understandably point out that this is mere greenwashing as fashion brands aim to superficially satisfy the expectations of an environmentally conscious generation by doing very little in actual truth. Today, fashion shows encapsulate multifaceted functions; they are not only platforms for artistic expression but also serve as catalysts for dialogue on pertinent social issues, including gender identity, cultural appropriation, and environmental sustainability.

1. What was the significance of Charles Frederick Worth's fashion show in 1903?
A) It marked the onset of sustainable fashion.
B) It formalised the use of live models on the runway.
C) It introduced high fashion to the working class.
D) It led to the decline of haute couture.

2. In what way did fashion shows of the 1920s reflect the cultural changes of the time?
A) They exclusively showcased traditional styles.
B) They promoted utilitarian and functional clothing.
C) They integrated music and dance to create immersive experiences.
D) They focused solely on male fashion.

3. How did the fashion shows of the 1960s challenge conventional norms?
A) By using teenage models.
B) By helping women rethink their place in society.
C) By prioritising female designers.
D) By eliminating the use of models in favour of mannequins.

4. What word best defines the impact of supermodels in the 1980s?
A) Selfish. **B)** Emancipatory. **C)** Double-edged. **D)** Conservative.

5. What is the writer's attitude towards the environmental awareness trend in the fashion industry?
A) They are incredulous. **B)** They are impressed by it.
C) They think it is an exaggeration. **D)** They think it is a result of digitalisation.

II. Read the first sentence. For the second sentence, choose the best answer for each gap (6-10) so that the meaning stays the same.

6. He was extremely tired after the long flight, but he still went to the meeting.
Despite being … the long flight, he went to the meeting.
A) at the end of **B)** broken down by **C)** worn out by

7. I'm sure it was the wind that woke me up.
It … the wind that woke me up.
A) should have been **B)** must have been **C)** can have been

8. That was John's biggest challenge ever.
John … before.
A) had not faced a biggest challenge
B) had not been up against a bigger challenge
C) has not faced a bigger challenge

9. He was able to pull himself together and finish the presentation despite his nerves.
Despite his nerves, he … and finished the presentation.
A) kept his cool **B)** held his head **C)** kept his cold feet

10. I would prefer you to speak more clearly during the presentation.
I … more clearly during the presentation.
A) would rather you spoke **B)** would rather you speak **C)** would rather you had spoken

Student

III. Read the text. For each question (11-20), choose the best answer.

Elizabeth Magie: The Real Inventor of Monopoly

Elizabeth Magie, born in 1866, was an American game designer and writer who is often overshadowed by the more famous name of Charles Darrow, the man widely credited with inventing the popular board game, Monopoly. However, it was Magie who **… (11)** the original idea for the game, which she called "The Landlord's Game", in 1903. She designed the game to demonstrate the economic theories of Henry George, specifically his views on the single tax system. Magie's creation was **… (12)** with the intention of educating people about the inequalities inherent in land monopolies. However, while the game was meant to encourage critical thinking, it didn't achieve widespread popularity in her lifetime. It wasn't until decades later that a version of her game **… (13)** by Darrow and his associates, who made a number of modifications and marketed it as their own. Despite the fact that her game never became a commercial success, Magie knew **… (14)** well that her invention had the potential to influence public-thinking about economic systems. She filed a patent for her game, but it was not until the 1930s, after Darrow's version hit the shelves, that people began to realise that she had been the true innovator behind Monopoly. **… (15)** Darrow's success, Elizabeth Magie never received recognition or financial compensation for her work. It wasn't until 1973, long after her death, that she was posthumously acknowledged as the original inventor. Still, her story remains largely untold, and many are **… (16)** to the fact that it was Magie, not Darrow, who first came up with the game that would become a household name. Magie's story highlights a significant issue in intellectual property rights, especially for women in male-dominated fields. Her invention was **… (17)** for years, and despite the game's fame, she lived much of her life in relative obscurity. **… (18)** the lack of recognition, her legacy has endured, and today, many recognise her as a pioneer in the world of board games. Despite all the challenges she faced, Elizabeth Magie's invention left an indelible **… (19)** on the world of entertainment, and the game she created continues to entertain millions of people worldwide. Magie's perseverance in continuing to fight for her rights **… (20)** serves as an inspiration to many who find themselves battling for recognition in a world full of obstacles.

11.	**A)** took	**B)** came up with	**C)** turned up with	**D)** set off with
12.	**A)** brought up	**B)** carried out	**C)** made up	**D)** designed
13.	**A)** was picked up	**B)** was sold	**C)** was turned down	**D)** was taken over
14.	**A)** totally	**B)** full	**C)** really	**D)** completely
15.	**A)** In spite of	**B)** Due to	**C)** Although	**D)** Thanks to
16.	**A)** ignorant	**B)** oblivious	**C)** dismissive	**D)** disregarded
17.	**A)** overlooked	**B)** overturned	**C)** oversight	**D)** overdone
18.	**A)** In light of	**B)** On behalf of	**C)** As a result of	**D)** In the face of
19.	**A)** mark	**B)** sign	**C)** touch	**D)** hint
20.	**A)** hardly	**B)** barely	**C)** unmistakably	**D)** certainly

IV. For each sentence (21-25), choose the right answer to define the phrase in italics.

21. Although the project seemed like a *wild goose chase* at the beginning, we eventually had an unexpected breakthrough and uncovered a solution.
A) hopeless pursuit **B)** great opportunity **C)** demonstrated failure

22. Despite the team's initial hesitation, they decided to *jump on the bandwagon*, realising it would be crucial for staying competitive in the market.
A) act against trending policies **B)** emulate trending transport strategies **C)** embrace the trend

23. His sudden outburst during the meeting came as a *bolt from the blue*, catching everyone off-guard.
A) great surprise **B)** slow burn **C)** big relief

24. After weeks of uncertainty, the company is finally *weathering the storm*, with the latest earnings report showing signs of stability.
A) reaching a consensus **B)** hitting the sack **C)** doing better

25. She tried to stay positive, but after hearing the latest criticism, her insecurity began to *snowball*, and soon she was doubting her every decision.
A) evaporate **B)** escalate **C)** dissipate

V. For each group of sentences (26-30), choose the word which can be used in all three gaps.

26. While hiking along the coastline, we spotted a … lounging on the rocks, basking in the sun.
The king pressed his royal … onto the parchment, thus making the decree legally binding.
Before the storm arrived, she decided to … the windows with tape to avoid water leakage.
A) seal **B)** fish **C)** ram **D)** hog

27. The startup founder gave a compelling … to investors, outlining the innovative and financial potential of his new app.
As the storm approached, the captain adjusted the ship's … to avoid the heavy swells that threatened to capsize them.
The football player's perfect … of the ball sent it spiralling past the goalkeeper, earning his team the winning goal.
A) proposition **B)** mast **C)** pitch **D)** goal

28. After the long hike, we found a clear … in the valley, its cool water providing much-needed relief from the heat.
She handled the unexpected criticism …, responding calmly and thoughtfully to each point.
His childhood was spent in a small village, and though they weren't … off, his family provided him a warm and loving home.
A) proper **B)** well **C)** spring **D)** trend

29. The director … the stage for the play with intricate props and lighting, creating an immersive atmosphere for the audience.
The tennis player … a new personal record, winning the match in straight sets to make the finals.
As the sun began to … over the horizon, the sky transformed into a breathtaking array of colours.
A) established **B)** rise **C)** climb **D)** set

30. The professor offered a … overview of the subject, covering its full scope from both historical and modern perspectives.
His … shoulders were well-suited to the demanding physical nature of his job, allowing him to lift heavy loads without strain.
The river was wide and …, stretching far beyond the horizon, its waves shimmering in sunlight.
A) large **B)** straight **C)** vast **D)** broad

VI. For questions 31-50, read and choose the correct answer.

31. What is the name of Beethoven's only opera?
A) Fidelio. **B)** Für Elise. **C)** Missa solemnis.
D) Rondo a Capriccio. **E)** Egmont.

32. Replace the italicised phrase with its correct meaning.
Jeremy graduated *summa cum laude* from the University of Manchester.
A) with a passing grade **B)** with highest honours
C) after a gap year **D)** as a foreign-exchange student
E) on a scholarship

33. The pigment that gives our skin its colour is called …
A) melanin. **B)** melatonin. **C)** mezzanine. **D)** melamine. **E)** metacin.

34. My father has an extremely high … of pain.
A) threshold **B)** limit **C)** edge **D)** border **E)** boundary

35. Which artist is known for his series of *Water Lilies* paintings?
A) Gustav Klimt. **B)** Paul Gauguin. **C)** Claude Monet. **D)** Henri Matisse.
E) Vincent van Gogh.

36. He is exactly like his father; they're like two …
A) peas in a pod. **B)** sides of a coin. **C)** acorns in a tree.
D) birds in a bush. **E)** halves of a whole.

37. Which Romanian film won the Palme d'Or (The Golden Palm) at the 2007 Cannes Film Festival?
A) Videograms of a Revolution. **B)** The Oak. **C)** 4 Months, 3 Weeks and 2 Days.
D) 12:08 East of Bucharest. **E)** Occident.

38. A tall tale is …
A) a story that's difficult to believe. **B)** the life story of a hero.
C) a story told by a tall person. **D)** a story about mountains.
E) an account of a significant event in history.

39. In 1893, which country became the first to enshrine international woman suffrage?
A) Finland. **B)** The U.S.A. **C)** New Zealand.
D) Great Britain. **E)** Denmark.

40. If someone does something gingerly, it means they are being …
A) cautious. **B)** stealthy. **C)** guilty. **D)** suspicious. **E)** deceitful.

41. As of now, … are the smallest known particles of matter.
A) quarks **B)** electrons **C)** atoms **D)** neutrons **E)** protons

42. "He has a laissez-faire attitude towards life", which means …
A) he believes in taking chances and living life to the fullest.
B) he is a workaholic and doesn't have time for much else.
C) he lets things unfold as they may, without interfering.
D) he pays keen attention to every detail around him.
E) he is a hedonist and over-indulges in pleasure.

43. Which country has the most time zones?
A) France. **B)** The U.S.A. **C)** Russia. **D)** Australia. **E)** United Kingdom.

44. The team's performance in the final left … desired.
A) too much **B)** much to be **C)** everything they
D) much that was **E)** many things

45. Who invented the World Wide Web?
A) Bill Gates. **B)** Steve Jobs. **C)** Larry Page.
D) Vinton Cerf. **E)** Timothy Berners-Lee.

46. Match the names of the punctuation marks in the left column with their symbols in the right column.

1.	Ellipses	**a.**	-
2.	Hyphen	**b.**	" "
3.	Parentheses	**c.**	;
4.	Semicolon	**d.**	…
5.	Quotation	**e.**	( )

A) 1e/2a/3b/4d/5c **B)** 1e/2d/3b/4c/5a **C)** 1d/2a/3e/4c/5b
D) 1d/2c/3e/4b/5a **E)** 1a/2d/3e/4c/5b

47. When Earth is at Perihelion, it is …
A) furthest from the sun. **B)** between the sun and the moon.
C) closest to the sun. **D)** closest to the moon.
E) furthest from the moon.

48. The film was not even remotely faithful to the book. It was a … and a …
A) hit/miss. **B)** trial/error. **C)** swing/miss.
D) swing/hit. **E)** gallop/thud.

49. What is the full form of GPS?
A) Geographic Positioning Satellite. **B)** Global Positioning System.
C) Geocentric Periodic System. **D)** Ground Placement Satellite.
E) Geological Placing System.

50. You're in a dark room with a candle, a wood stove, and a gas lamp. You only have one match. What do you light first?
A) The candle. **B)** The wood stove. **C)** The gas lamp.
D) The match. **E)** The room.